

PROOFS FOR THE EXISTENCE OF GOD AND THEIR CRITIQUE

PROOF ARCHITECTURE → ONTOLOGICAL LINE → COSMOLOGICAL FAMILY → DESIGN AND FINE-TUNING → MORAL ARGUMENT → NYĀYA-UDAYANA PROOF CLUSTER

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g14 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00

PROOF ARCHITECTURE

PROOF ARCHITECTURETHEISTIC ARGUMENTS START FROM DIFFERENT DATACONCEPT OF GODONTOLOGICAL (A PRIORI)CONTINGENT/MOVED/CAUSED WORLDCOSMOLOGICAL (A POSTERIORI)ORDER AND PURPOSIVENESSOBJECTIVE OBLIGATION

THEISTIC ARGUMENTS START FROM DIFFERENT DATA

concept of God → ONTOLOGICAL (a priori)

contingent/moved/caused world → COSMOLOGICAL (a posteriori)

order and purposiveness → TELEOLOGICAL

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

THEISTIC ARGUMENTS START FROM DIFFERENT DATA
concept of God → ONTOLOGICAL (a priori)
contingent/moved/caused world → COSMOLOGICAL (a posteriori)

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

order and purposiveness → TELEOLOGICAL
objective obligation → MORAL
Indian effect/order/language/karma → NYĀYA-UDAYANA

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

CONTROL: proofs may be deductive, abductive or cumulative
never judge all by the standard of a single demonstrative syllogism.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Classify each proof's force, then test premise, inference and theological identification separately; 'proof' does not guarantee demonstration.

01

STAGE 01

ONTOLOGICAL LINE

ONTOLOGICAL LINETHAT THAN WHICH GREATER CAN BE CONCEIVED EXISTINGNECESSARY EXISTENCE BELONGS TO SUPREMELY PERFECT BEINGMODAL FORMPOSSIBLY NECESSARY GODNECESSARILY GOD, IF S5 POSSIBILITY IS GRANTEDPERFECT-ISLAND PARODY

EXISTENCE IS NOT A REAL PREDICATE REPLY

DOCTRINE / CLAIM

ANSELM: God = that than which nothing greater can be conceived existing in reality existing only in understanding
therefore the greatest conceivable being exists in reality

OBJECTION / PRESSURE

DESCARTES: necessary existence belongs to supremely perfect being
MODAL FORM: possibly necessary God → necessarily God, if S5 possibility is granted

REPLY / RESIDUAL

GAUNILLO: perfect-island parody
KANT: existence is not a real predicate reply: necessary being is unlike contingent islands; pressure shifts to coherent possibility.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Anselm promises necessary existence, but Gaunilo and Kant shift the burden to coherent possibility and the legitimacy of existential predication.

02

STAGE 02

COSMOLOGICAL FAMILY

COSMOLOGICAL FAMILYUNMOVED MOVEREFFICIENT CAUSESFIRST CAUSE CONTINGENCYNECESSARY BEING; NOT 'EVERY EVENT HAS A CAUSE'WHATEVER BEGINS HAS A CAUSE; UNIVERSE BEGAN; THEREFORE APRINCIPLE OF SUFFICIENT REASONWHY SOMETHING RATHER THAN NOTHING?

AQUINAS: motion → unmoved mover

efficient causes → first cause contingency → necessary being; not "every event has a cause"

KALĀM: whatever begins has a cause; universe began; therefore a cause

LEIBNIZ: principle of sufficient reason → why something rather than nothing?

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

AQUINAS: motion → unmoved mover
efficient causes → first cause contingency → necessary being; not "every event has a cause"
KALĀM: whatever begins has a cause; universe began; therefore a cause

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

LEIBNIZ: principle of sufficient reason → why something rather than nothing?
HUME: causal principle may not extend beyond experience; universe may be brute
RUSSELL: universe is "just there"; composition fallacy

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

REPLY: argument concerns contingent totality's explanation, not a member-cause in time.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Aquinas explains present dependence, Leibniz contingent totality and the kalam a temporal beginning; each faces a different regress or brute-fact pressure.

03

STAGE 03

DESIGN AND FINE-TUNING

DESIGN AND FINE-TUNINGCOMPLEX PURPOSIVE ADAPTATIONWATCHMAKER ANALOGYLIFE-PERMITTING CONSTANTS APPEAR WITHIN NARROW RANGE RIVAL EXPLANATIONSPHYSICAL NECESSITYMULTIVERSE + SELECTION EFFECTUNKNOWN DEEPER LAW

WEAK ANALOGY, MANY DESIGNERS, IMPERFECT DESIGNER

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	EVALUATION / TRAP
PALEY: complex purposive adaptation → watchmaker analogy → designer	chance / multiverse + selection effect	DARWIN: adaptation by selection verdict: modern design is probabilistic/abductive, not Paley's biological inference unchanged.
FINE-TUNING: life-permitting constants appear within narrow range rival explanations	unknown deeper law	
physical necessity	HUME: weak analogy, many designers, imperfect designer	

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE

PALEY: complex purposive adaptation → watchmaker analogy → designer
FINE-TUNING: life-permitting constants appear within narrow range rival explanations
physical necessity

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

chance / multiverse + selection effect
unknown deeper law
HUME: weak analogy, many designers, imperfect designer

EVALUATION / TRAP

DARWIN: adaptation by selection verdict: modern design is probabilistic/abductive, not Paley's biological inference unchanged.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — HUME: weak analogy, many designers, imperfect designer | DARWIN: adaptation by selection verdict: modern design is probabilistic/abductive, not Paley's biological inference unchanged.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Hume defeats a demonstrative design inference and its rich divine attributes; teleology survives, if at all, as contested probabilistic explanation.

04

STAGE 04

MORAL ARGUMENT

MORAL ARGUMENTMORALITY DOES NOT THEORETICALLY PROVE GOD HIGHEST GOOD (VIRTUE)PRACTICAL POSTULATESFREEDOM + IMMORTALITY + GOD CONTEMPORARY ROUTEOBJECTIVE MORAL OBLIGATIONSADEQUATE PERSONAL GROUND OBJECTION

EUTHYPHRO DILEMMA; SECULAR REALISM CAN GROUND MORAL FACTS REPLYMODIFIED DIVINE COMMAND GROUNDS OBLIGATION IN COMMANDS FLOWING FROM

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

KANT: morality does not theoretically prove God highest good (virtue proportioned to happiness) → practical postulates
freedom + immortality + God contemporary route: objective moral obligations → adequate personal ground objection: Euthyphro dilemma

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

secular realism can ground moral facts reply: modified divine command grounds obligation in commands flowing from good nature
KANT: morality does not theoretically prove God highest good (virtue proportioned to happiness) → practical postulates

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

freedom + immortality + God contemporary route: objective moral obligations → adequate personal ground objection: Euthyphro dilemma
secular realism can ground moral facts reply: modified divine command grounds obligation in commands flowing from good nature

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Lawgiver, objective-value and Kantian highest-good arguments begin from different moral data and do not establish the same conclusion.

05

STAGE 05

NYĀYA-UDAYANA PROOF CLUSTER

NYĀYA-UDAYANA PROOF CLUSTERUDAYANA'S ROUTES TO ĪŚVARA KĀRYĀT WORLD AS EFFECTMAKER ĀYOJANĀTATOMIC COMBINATIONARRANGER DHṚTYĀDEHSUPPORT/DISSOLUTION PADĀTCONVENTIONAL WORD-USE PRATYAYATAH

UDAYANA'S ROUTES TO ĪŚVARA kāryāt: world as effect → maker āyojanāt: atomic combination → arranger

conventional word-use pratyayatah: trustworthy cognition śruteh/vākyaṭ: Vedic discourse saṃkhyāvivēṣaṭ: determinate magnitudes adṛṣṭāḥ: karmic allocation

ĪŚVARA = omniscient efficient cause

eternal atoms = material causes not creation ex nihilo

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

UDAYANA'S ROUTES TO ĪŚVARA kāryāt: world as effect → maker āyojanāt: atomic combination → arranger dhṛtyādeḥ: support/dissolution padāt
conventional word-use pratyayatah: trustworthy cognition śruteh/vākyaṭ: Vedic discourse saṃkhyāvivēṣaṭ: determinate magnitudes adṛṣṭāḥ: karmic allocation

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

ĪŚVARA = omniscient efficient cause
eternal atoms = material causes not creation ex nihilo

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

proof aims at intelligent coordination of a realist cosmos.
UDAYANA'S ROUTES TO ĪŚVARA kāryāt: world as effect → maker āyojanāt: atomic combination → arranger dhṛtyādeḥ: support/dissolution padāt

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Udayana's cumulative proof cluster infers an omniscient efficient cause that orders eternal atoms and karmic fruits rather than creating matter.

06

STAGE 06

INDIAN AND WESTERN CRITIQUES

INDIAN AND WESTERN CRITIQUESNO PERCEPTION OF GOD; INFERENCE OVERREACHESMOMENTARY DEPENDENT SERIES NEEDS NO PERMANENT CREATORBEGINNINGLESS JIVA/AJIVA AND KARMA; CREATION MAKES GOD RESPONSIBLE FORVEDA IS AUTHORLESS; DHARMA/APŪRVA EXPLAINS RITUAL FRUIT WITHOUT DIVINECAUSAL/DESIGN INFERENCE EXCEEDS CATEGORIES OR EXPERIENCENYĀYA REPLYUNCONSCIOUS ATOMS, APŪRVA OR KARMA CANNOT INTELLIGENTLY ALLOCATE ORDER

DOCTRINE / CLAIM	OBJECTION / PRESSURE	REPLY / RESIDUAL
CĀRVĀKA: no perception of God; inference overreaches	MIMĀMSĀ: Veda is authorless; dharma/apūrva explains ritual fruit without divine author	
BUDDHIST: momentary dependent series needs no permanent creator	HUME/KANT: causal/design inference exceeds categories or experience	COUNTER: coordination may show explanatory gap, not uniquely the Nyāya God.
JAINA: beginningless jiva/ajiva and karma; creation makes God responsible for evil	NYĀYA REPLY: unconscious atoms, apūrva or karma cannot intelligently allocate order	

DOCTRINE / CLAIM

CĀRVĀKA: no perception of God; inference overreaches
BUDDHIST: momentary dependent series needs no permanent creator
JAINA: beginningless jiva/ajiva and karma; creation makes God responsible for evil

OBJECTION / PRESSURE

MIMĀMSĀ: Veda is authorless; dharma/apūrva explains ritual fruit without divine author
HUME/KANT: causal/design inference exceeds categories or experience
NYĀYA REPLY: unconscious atoms, apūrva or karma cannot intelligently allocate order

REPLY / RESIDUAL

COUNTER: coordination may show explanatory gap, not uniquely the Nyāya God.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Jain, Buddhist, Mimamsa, Samkhya and Carvaka critiques relocate explanatory work differently and must not be flattened into one atheistic objection.

07

STAGE 07

CUMULATIVE VERDICT AND ANSWER PLAN

CUMULATIVE VERDICT AND ANSWER PLANDEFINE TARGET GODCLASSIFY ARGUMENTFORMALISE PREMISESEXPOSE HIDDEN BRIDGESTRONGEST NAMED CRITICBEST REPLYTEST WHAT CONCLUSION ACTUALLY ESTABLISHES ONTOLOGICAL

DEFINE target God → classify argument → formalise premises → expose hidden bridge

strongest named critic → best reply → test what conclusion actually establishes ontological: necessity if

cosmological: ground if PSR design: probability, not deduction

moral: practical/normative support

Nyāya: intelligent order within atomism

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE

DEFINE target God → classify argument → formalise premises → expose hidden bridge
strongest named critic → best reply → test what conclusion actually establishes ontological: necessity if possibility
cosmological: ground if PSR design: probability, not deduction

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

moral: practical/normative support
Nyaya: intelligent order within atomism
QUALIFIED VERDICT: no proof compels every rational agent

EVALUATION / TRAP

together they can form a cumulative case only if their contested modal, causal, probabilistic and moral premises stand.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — QUALIFIED VERDICT: no proof compels every rational agent; together they can form a cumulative case only if their contested modal, causal, probabilistic and moral premises stand.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: No single proof compels; a cumulative case can raise probability only if its modal, causal, analogical and moral premises retain independent force.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENTADVANCED CARDS MOVED FROM THE COMPLETE LEARNER SOURCE —CANONICAL ADVANCED DOCTRINE DOSSIERS — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]PHILOSOPHY OF RELIGION DOSSIERTOPIC 2 — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]DOCTRINE STATEMENT.

ANSELM ARGUES A PRIORI FROM THE CONCEPT OF GOD(1) EVEN THE DENIER UNDERSTANDS THE CONCEPT

OPTIONAL SOURCE WITNESS

Advanced cards moved from the complete learner source — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]
Canonical advanced doctrine dossiers — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]
Philosophy of Religion dossier: Topic 2 — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]
Doctrine statement.

ADVANCED OBJECTION

Anselm argues a priori from the concept of God as that than which no greater can be conceived to existence not merely in understanding but in reality.
Argument.
(1) Even the denier understands the concept
(2) existing in reality is greater than existing only in understanding

COMPARATIVE NUANCE

(3) If God existed only in understanding, a greater could be conceived.
(4) contradiction
therefore God exists.
Descartes recasts existence as inseparable from supremely perfect being.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.